Business

1. Moderna has just revised its 2026 revenue growth forecast upward — significantly. What is the new target range the company is now guiding investors toward?
   a. 15% to 25% growth
   b. 5% to 15% growth
   c. 30% to 40% growth

2. Cream cheese brands have recently flagged an unusual threat to their sales. Which viral consumer trend is most directly eating into cream cheese demand?
   a. The sourdough baking revival pushing consumers toward butter instead
   b. The protein-maxxing craze driving shoppers to cottage cheese
   c. A TikTok-led 'dairy-free January' movement gaining year-round traction

3. Tesla recently announced it will wind down Cybertruck production next year. The factory space freed up will be used to ramp up production of which vehicle?
   a. A refreshed Model Y aimed at the European market
   b. The Cybercab robotaxi
   c. A lower-cost Model 2 for emerging markets

4. Legacy carmakers are sounding the alarm about 2027. Which combination of pressures is squeezing the global auto industry right now?
   a. Rising commodity, logistics and memory chip costs, plus shrinking pricing power
   b. Falling steel prices and a sudden collapse in EV subsidies
   c. A shortage of skilled workers and a glut of unsold electric vehicles in Asia

Economics

5. The US Federal Reserve's preferred inflation gauge — the PCE index (Personal Consumption Expenditures index, which tracks what households actually spend money on) — recently showed that inflation accelerated in October. Why does the Fed prefer the PCE over the better-known CPI?
   a. The PCE updates more frequently and covers a wider range of goods and services
   b. The PCE adjusts for how consumers switch between products when prices rise, making it a more flexible measure
   c. The PCE strips out food and energy by default, giving a cleaner read on underlying prices

6. The Bank of England recently raised its key interest rate to 4% — its first increase in over three years — citing rising prices partly linked to the Iran conflict. Which of these is NOT typically a risk when a central bank raises interest rates?
   a. Mortgage holders face higher monthly repayments
   b. Business investment slows as borrowing becomes more expensive
   c. Inflation accelerates because consumers have more money to spend

7. A key highway linking China to Europe through Central Asia has recently been expanded, cutting transit times and transport costs. This route is part of a broader network sometimes called the 'Middle Corridor.' Which sea does this corridor cross to avoid going through Russia?
   a. The Black Sea
   b. The Caspian Sea
   c. The Aral Sea

8. A new study on European retirement savings found that workers need to put aside far more than most people realise to retire on 70% of their working income. How much extra do Swiss workers on average wages need to save each month to hit that target?
   a. Around €300 per month
   b. Around €650 per month
   c. Over €1,000 per month

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal that sits at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and is sometimes called 'white gold'?
   a. Chile
   b. Australia
   c. China

10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the line 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?
   a. David Ricardo
   b. Adam Smith
   c. Thomas Malthus

Business

1. Moderna has just revised its 2026 revenue growth forecast upward — significantly. What is the new target range the company is now guiding investors toward?

a. Moderna now expects revenue to grow 15% to 25% in 2026. That is a big jump from its previous guidance of up to 10% growth, driven by stronger-than-expected uptake of its newer vaccines. For context, Moderna's share price soared after the COVID pandemic but has fallen sharply since — so this upward revision is a rare piece of good news for investors who have had a rough few years.

2. Cream cheese brands have recently flagged an unusual threat to their sales. Which viral consumer trend is most directly eating into cream cheese demand?

b. The protein-maxxing trend — where people chase extreme protein intake as part of fitness culture — has sent shoppers flocking to cottage cheese and away from cream cheese. US cottage cheese sales have more than doubled since 2021. One brand executive reportedly said, 'We're losing to cottage cheese,' which is not a sentence anyone expected to hear in a boardroom.

3. Tesla recently announced it will wind down Cybertruck production next year. The factory space freed up will be used to ramp up production of which vehicle?

b. Tesla is clearing the decks for its Cybercab robotaxi by winding down Cybertruck production. The Cybertruck launched with enormous hype but never achieved mass-market sales, hampered by its polarising design and high price tag. The Cybercab represents Elon Musk's bet that autonomous ride-hailing is the real prize — though Tesla has been promising fully self-driving cars for the better part of a decade.

4. Legacy carmakers are sounding the alarm about 2027. Which combination of pressures is squeezing the global auto industry right now?

a. Automakers are caught in a painful squeeze: input costs — including commodities, shipping and chips — are rising, while their ability to pass those costs on to consumers is fading fast. Pricing power (the ability to charge more without losing customers) boomed during the post-COVID supply crunch, but that era is ending. Manufacturers who built their profit forecasts on premium pricing are now having to rethink.

Economics

5. The US Federal Reserve's preferred inflation gauge — the PCE index (Personal Consumption Expenditures index, which tracks what households actually spend money on) — recently showed that inflation accelerated in October. Why does the Fed prefer the PCE over the better-known CPI?

b. The PCE is preferred partly because it accounts for substitution — the fact that when beef gets expensive, people buy chicken instead. The CPI (Consumer Price Index) uses a fixed basket of goods that doesn't fully capture this real-world behaviour. The October acceleration matters because the Fed uses PCE data to decide whether to cut or hold interest rates, so a hotter reading makes near-term rate cuts less likely.

6. The Bank of England recently raised its key interest rate to 4% — its first increase in over three years — citing rising prices partly linked to the Iran conflict. Which of these is NOT typically a risk when a central bank raises interest rates?

c. Raising interest rates is specifically designed to slow spending and cool inflation — so accelerating inflation is not a risk of the policy, it is what the policy is trying to prevent. Higher rates work by making borrowing costlier and saving more attractive, which dampens demand across the economy. The genuine risks are the ones in options a and b: mortgage pain for households and a chilling effect on business investment.

7. A key highway linking China to Europe through Central Asia has recently been expanded, cutting transit times and transport costs. This route is part of a broader network sometimes called the 'Middle Corridor.' Which sea does this corridor cross to avoid going through Russia?

b. The Middle Corridor runs from China through Kazakhstan, across the Caspian Sea by ferry, then through Azerbaijan and Georgia toward Europe. It gained strategic importance after Russia's invasion of Ukraine made the northern overland route through Russia less attractive to shippers. Journey times and costs on the route have been falling as infrastructure improves, though bureaucratic border delays remain a bottleneck.

8. A new study on European retirement savings found that workers need to put aside far more than most people realise to retire on 70% of their working income. How much extra do Swiss workers on average wages need to save each month to hit that target?

c. Swiss workers need to save over €1,000 extra every month on top of existing pension contributions to retire comfortably on 70% of their salary — a figure most people would find startling. Even Germany, which has a relatively generous state pension, requires workers to put aside over €600 monthly. The gap between what people are saving and what they actually need is one of the quiet financial crises facing ageing European societies.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal that sits at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and is sometimes called 'white gold'?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer by volume, accounting for roughly half of global mine output. Chile holds the largest known reserves — stored in vast salt flat brines in the Atacama Desert — and is the second-largest producer. China dominates the downstream processing of lithium, meaning it refines much of what Australia and Chile dig up, giving it significant leverage over the global battery supply chain.

10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the line 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?

b. Adam Smith wrote this in 'The Wealth of Nations,' published in 1776 — the same year as American independence. The line captures his central insight: that self-interest, channelled through markets, can produce outcomes that benefit everyone, without anyone planning it. Smith is often called the father of modern economics, though he was actually a moral philosopher by training, and his earlier book 'The Theory of Moral Sentiments' is just as important to understanding his full argument.